Grammar BM · Resit Cheat Sheet

Resit Fri 9 Oct 2026 · 09:00–11:00 · RUB Online-Exam · [numbers] = page in the official Theory Reader SoSe 2026 · Trainer: sirmrba.github.io/grammar-sprint/resit/

Your 10 July traps – check these first

1. **Add the preposition** – it belongs in the gap: insist **on** travelling · interested **in** listening. If it is already printed (*was used to (do)*, *looking forward to (enter)*), type only the -ing form. [11–12]
2. **suggest / consider (= think about) + -ing:** suggested **going** (~~**to go**~~) · considered **leaving** (~~**to leave**~~). [6, 10]
3. **Simple past is the default.** Past perfect only if something is **earlier** than another past point: he **wasn't** there at 8:59 (~~**hadn't been**~~). [15–16]
4. **Background in progress → past progressive:** we **were having** a bad time · somebody **was feeling** around in a drawer, and there at the back was … [16]
5. **Narrator's NOW inside a past story:** whom I **will call** "Chuck" for the following story · I **regret** that … I would not be telling the truth now … [14, 17]
6. **Future seen from the past → would (be -ing):** we had expected that he **would be standing** there. [17, 19]
7. **If-clause: read the main clause first.** would → if + past (**spent**) · would have → if + past perfect (**had simply reused**). [18]
8. **Modal signals:** *convinced* → must · *Surely …?* → can't have · *…, but* → may (have) · ___ *better* → had · *only years later* → was to · *typical of him* → would · *no reason to think* → needn't · *feared* → might · *told us we only* ___ → had to. [21–24]
9. **Relatives:** after a name → comma: `, who` · object in a defining clause → `C` · no antecedent at all (what = the thing that) → `what`; after he / those / anyone → `who` · many/some/two → `of whom` · named place → `, where` (defining: at a time `when` · the day `C`). [27–30]
10. **MC:** regret **to** = now / regret **-ing** = past · condition names go by **form** · a real past (yesterday) is not modal past · contact clause = **0** pronouns · no commas = only some · **no** inversion after no doubt / in no time / nonetheless · **my own**.

Moodle input rules

- Read the **whole text** before filling anything (both text tasks say so).
- Type exactly what goes in the gap – preposition included (`on travelling`), comma included (`, who`), `C` for a contact clause (the exam rule says that if C is possible, you must choose it).
- Bracketed adverbs: after the **first auxiliary** (`had simply reused`, `would not constantly be`); before a simple verb (`permanently kept`); degree/manner adverbs after **all** auxiliaries (`will have been completely ruined`).
- Spelling counts: regre**tt**ed, sto**pp**ed, prefe**rr**ed (stressed last syllable doubles; but visited, offered) · trave**ll**ed BE / traveled AE.
- Contractions: type the straight apostrophe `'` (Shift + #), never ' or ´ – Moodle rejects them.
- Drag & drop: fill the sure gaps first. If you have used an item twice, check again.
- Time: non-finites 12 · tense 25 · modals 15 · relatives 10 · MC 18 · final check 10 min.

1 · Non-finite verb forms [5–12]

Gerund only (-ing)

admit · appreciate · avoid · can't help · can't stand · carry on · **consider** (= think about) · contemplate · delay · deny · dislike · enjoy · escape · excuse · fancy · forgive · give up · imagine · involve · keep (on) · mention · mind · miss · practise · prevent · recall · resent · resume · risk · **suggest** · tolerate

feel like · it's no use/good · it's (not) worth · there's no point (in) · be busy · burst out · look forward to · prefer doing to doing · nouns: key to · alternative to · hope of · idea of · risk of

to-infinitive

afford · appear · arrange · ask · choose · claim · decide · demand · expect · fail · happen · hesitate · hope · manage · offer · pretend · promise · refuse · seem · tend · threaten · want · wish · nouns: decision · promise · refusal · permission … to · adjectives: able · likely · pleased · surprised … to

Bare infinitive

make / let / have sb **do** · would rather / sooner · rather than · why (not)

Either – same meaning

begin · start · continue · cease · can't bear · bother · neglect · omit · fear. But no -ing after -ing: is starting **to** rise.

advise · allow · permit · forbid · encourage · urge: **+ -ing** without a person (I don't allow smoking) / **sb + to** (I don't allow visitors to smoke).

Change in meaning

verb	+ -ing	+ to
remember / forget	memory of the past	a duty (Remember to call!)
regret	sorry about the past (regret turning down / having turned down)	sorry about what I'm about to say (regret to inform you)
stop	no longer do it	in order to do it
try	experiment	attempt
mean	involve	intend
go on	continue the same	next step
consider	think about	sb to be = regard as
be afraid	of doing (accident)	to do (in control)

Preposition → -ing [11]

insist **on** · interested **in** · succeed **in** · object **to** · look forward **to** · be/get used **to** · apologise **for** · think **of** · instead of · without · by · after · before

used to do = past habit (infinitive marker) · **be used to doing** = be accustomed (preposition). [12]

need / deserve / require / want + -ing = passive meaning: it needs **discussing** = it needs **to be discussed**. [12]

see / hear / feel sb **do** = the whole action · sb **doing** = action in progress (incomplete). [11]

July ✗ suggested to go · insisted traveling · considered to leave · interested listening

2 · Tense & aspect [13–19]

Ask for every gap

① Whose time – the story's past or the narrator's now? ② Is it **earlier** than another past point? → past perfect. ③ In progress / background / temporary behaviour? → progressive. ④ Future seen from the past? → would (be -ing). ⑤ An if-clause? → look at the main clause first.

Present

Simple present: habits · timeless truths · commentaries · historic present (also *I hear you have finally changed your mind*) · timetable future · after when / as soon as / if with future meaning · state verbs (know, believe, belong, see, regret).

Present progressive: incomplete or temporary · *always* = annoyance · arrangement (We're spending our holidays in Canada) · be + adjective = temporary behaviour (*You are being silly*).

Past

Present perfect: unspecified past (just, already, ever) · up to now (for, since) · result. A definite past time (yesterday, in 1997, at 8:59) → **simple past**.

Past progressive: frame (at 11 I was reading) · time inclusion (When she was having lunch, the phone rang) · simultaneity · temporary habit.

Past perfect: only for something earlier than a past point of orientation (When the police arrived, the thieves had run away).

Future [17]

will	spontaneous decision · prediction · promise
going to	present intention · conclusion from evidence
present progressive	intention with present arrangement
simple present	timetable / future as fact
will be -ing	in progress at a future time · matter of course
will have done	completed before a future point (future II)

Conditionals [18]

name (by form!)	if-clause	main clause
probable	present	will + inf
improbable	past (were)	would + inf
impossible	past perfect	would have + pp

Modal functions in the if-clause: **should** = improbability (If he should call, …) · **were to** = supposition · **will / would** = politeness or willingness (If you **won't** leave a man in peace = refuse to).

Modal past (hypothetical): wish · if only · as if · it's (high) time · I'd rather + past; **were** for every person. A real past with a time marker is not modal past. [15–16]

Reported speech: with a past reporting verb, backshift: present → past · past / present perfect → past perfect · will → would. These modals stay: must (supposition), ought to, used to, had better, could, would, should, might. [19]

July ✗ had (were having) · called (will call) · looks (looked) · had not been (wasn't) · stood (would be standing) · had been (was being) · spend (spent) · simply reused (had simply reused) · felt (was feeling) · regreted (regret)

3 · Modals [20–25]

meaning	modal	example / signal
deduction: sure yes	must · must have + pp	*I'm convinced he must be running a distillery.*
deduction: sure no	can't / couldn't have + pp	*Surely you can't have missed the point?*
expectation	should · ought to	you should pass
possibility	may (factual) · can (theoretical) · could · might (less likely)	*He feared others might try …*
strong obligation	must (speaker) · have to (external)	*It's 2 a.m. You must come home earlier.*
past obligation	had to (past of must)	*Someone told us we only had to …*
advice	should · ought to · **had better** (+ threat)	*You had better mind your own business.*
no obligation	needn't · don't need/have to	*You needn't think there was a third attempt.*
prohibition	mustn't (strong) · may not · cannot	mustn't ≠ needn't!
permission	may · can · could · might (very polite)	
willingness	will · would · shall (formal)	will = request, intention, **promise**
ability	can · could (general past) · **was able to** (= could and did)	*He was able to hide every trace.*
concession	may (have) … but	*He may have been uneducated, but …*
be to	order · official plan · **fate**	*It was only years later that I was to learn …* (sollte erst … erfahren)
be supposed to	rumour · expectation · intention	*Was that supposed to be a compliment?*
typical behaviour	will (present) · **would** (past)	*He would! That was typical of him.*
discontinued habit	used to	*Uncle Joe used to vanish …*
boldness	dare (+ bare inf as modal)	*How dare you … · I dare say …*

Perfect infinitive: could / might have done = (a) possible, but it did not happen (*Max could have married Sam*) or (b) an unsure guess about the past (*I think he might have overheard us*, July key) · may have …, but = concession · needn't have done = done, but unnecessary · must / can't have done = sure deduction about the past. [21, 23–24]

Question tags: Sit down, won't you? · Don't tell anybody, will you? · Shut the window, will you? [25]

German "sollen": should / ought to · had better · be to · be supposed / said to.

July ✗ had to be running (must) · must give (had to) · might have been … but (may have) · shall better (had) · had to have missed (can't) · might think (needn't) · was able to learn (was to) · would try (might) · needn't have (would)

4 · Relative clauses [27–31]

Comma test: can the clause be removed and turned into a new sentence? → non-defining → **commas** (names, unique things). No commas = defining = it restricts: *The travellers who knew* = only some of them.

case	defining (no comma)	non-defining (commas)
subject	who / that · which / that – **never C**	, who · , which
object	who(m) / that / which / **C** → write **C**	, who(m) · , which
preposition	at whom / which · or **C** … at	, with whom · , for which
genitive	whose	, whose · , the history of which
partitive	–	, many / some / two **of whom** · **of which**

- **that** never after a comma. **C** only in defining clauses, never for the subject; also after time nouns (*the day C Hale-Bopp …*).
- **, which** can refer to a whole clause (connective): *Jill called me a pig, which I found insulting.*
- **what** = that which (no antecedent): *for what they thought would be a trip*.
- **, where / , when** only in non-defining clauses after a name or an already identified place/time: *in Rancho Santa Fe, where they ran a business*. Defining = no comma: *at a time when this was a good way …* (mock) · *the day C Hale-Bopp …*
- whoever / whatever / whichever = no matter who / what; present tense for the future. Cleft: *It was he who …*

July ✗ Applewhite who (, who) · compound which (C) · Rancho Santa Fe , (, where) · Heaven's Gate C (, who) · for who (what) · many who (of whom)

5 · Word order [32–37]

Mid position: before the main verb, after am/is/was, after the **first auxiliary** (We will probably have arrived). Degree and manner adverbs go after all auxiliaries (will have been completely ruined). With a contracted negative, the adverb comes first (I probably won't).

End position: manner – place – time (after verbs of motion: place – manner – time).

Inversion after negative or restrictive front adverbials: never · seldom · scarcely · barely · hardly · rarely · only · not only · no sooner · nowhere · under no circumstances · on no account · on no condition · no way · few · little · so · such · neither · nor. Simple verb → **do**: *Rarely did she visit* · *So severe did the symptoms become*. Compound verb or be → no do: *Never have I seen* · *So great was my surprise*.

NO inversion: no doubt · in no time · nevertheless · nonetheless · occasionally · without exception · not far from · not long after · even so · with no difficulty at all.

here / there / up / down / off / back + **noun** → inversion (*Here comes the bride!*); + **pronoun** → none (*Off we go!*).

Adverbs of time: soon · still · recently · lately ≠ frequency: sometimes · often · usually. *He spoke even to me* = to me of all people.

6 · Determiners [38–40]

the: unique things (the earth) · made definite by a clause or of-phrase · superlatives, ordinals, only · the + adjective = a group of people (the dead) · rivers, seas, mountain chains, island groups, deserts, plural countries (the USA) · instruments and dances.

No the: abstract and uncountable nouns in general (life, sugar) · plural classes (Dogs with long legs …) · names, continents, countries, towns, streets, lakes · body parts and clothes → possessive (his hand; but *hit me in the stomach*) · school, church, hospital, prison as institutions · man (= mankind) · illnesses (appendicitis; but the flu, a cold).

a / an: countable singular · a class (A cow has horns) · professions (She is a teacher) – but **no article** for unique positions and titles (appointed *Head of Department*) · a dozen, a hundred · 60 miles an hour · What a day! · **a few / a little** = some.

few / little without an article = hardly any: *Few people know this*; *hardly any rain* = little rain. But: *A few of my friends work abroad*.

No a / an: plurals · abstract nouns · uncountable nouns (advice, information, news) · materials · meals (have breakfast; but a good breakfast) · **own** → **my / her own**.

7 · MC traps July + mock test

- Underline **NOT** / **How many … do not** – then count the wrong ones.
- regret **to** + past time = wrong · regret **-ing / having done** = right → "how many are not correct?" = 2.
- *If I became President, I would …* = **improbable** (by form – not impossible).
- Modal past: *as if he were* · *it's high time you started* · *I wish I had never come*. Not: *you came home early yesterday*.
- Contact clause = **0** relative pronouns; the pronoun can be left out **only in defining** clauses.
- Present progressive for the future = **intention with present arrangement**. will = promise. must = strong obligation (speaker's authority).
- *cannot have escaped* = impossibility · *could have danced all night* = ability, not performed.
- *When you take a look …, you will understand* – no will in the time clause.
- *are being silly* = temporary behaviour · *I hear you have …* = historic present.
- Inversion with compound verbs: **no** do-paraphrase.
- Head of Department → no article · own → possessive determiner · a few of my friends = some · hardly any rain = little rain.
- *…, which I found insulting* → which refers to the whole preceding clause.

Made for the resit on 9 Oct 2026 from the July attempt review, the official Theory Reader SoSe 2026 and the Moodle mock test. Keys for the July non-finite, tense and relative tasks are not printed in Moodle and were reconstructed from the reader; was being and regret are the less certain ones.